Dr. Mahla (Fatemeh) Alizadeh

Human-AI Interaction Researcher

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PROFILE

HCI researcher studying how people live with AI systems as they move from tools to companions and teammates. Six years of research on human-AI relationships, AI manipulation and deception, and accountability, grounded in longitudinal, naturalistic studies of everyday AI use. PhD in Information Systems with organisational psychology theory; master's degrees in Artificial Intelligence and Human-Computer Interaction. Experienced in leading interdisciplinary teams and working across technical and non-technical communities.

EXPERIENCE

Group Lead & Project Coordinator June 2026 – present

Institute of Positive Computing, Ruhr West University of Applied Sciences, Germany

- Lead the research group on KI-InnOMATiV, an EU-funded project on AI for inclusive onboarding in public administration; mentor group members
- Own the project's work on trust, acceptance, data protection and participatory design of human-AI teaming
- Designed speculative design workshops using participatory backcasting and bilingual design-fiction materials
- Ran a between-subjects chatbot study comparing interaction styles, grounded in self-efficacy theory

Research Associate & Lecturer April 2020 – 2026

Chair of Information Systems, esp. Data Protection and IT Security (Prof. Gunnar Stevens), University of Siegen, Germany

- Led the CheckMyVA living lab: followed households with Alexa and Google Assistant for three years and built a tool that let them see and interact with their own voice-assistant data
- Researched how people make sense of voice assistants, chatbots and AI decision-making in everyday life
- Studied social engineering, fraud and deception, and trust in AI-assisted decision making
- Designed and taught master's courses in HCI; supervised student theses

Visiting Researcher 2023

Eindhoven University of Technology, Netherlands

- Research stay with Dr. Minha Lee on conversational agents and human-AI relationships

EDUCATION

PhD in Information Systems (Dr.) 2025

University of Siegen, Germany · Dissertation: Everyday Life Encounters with AI: An Inquiry into Users' Sensemaking

MSc Human-Computer Interaction

MSc Artificial Intelligence

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- **Alizadeh, M.**, Lee, M., Randall, D., Tolmie, P., Pins, D., & Stevens, G. (2026). Finding a Home for Voice Assistants: A Domestication Calculus Across Three Years and Thirty Households. CHI ’26.
- Amirkhani, S., **Alizadeh, M.**, Randall, D., Stevens, G., & Zytko, D. (2025). “Society Encourages the Killing of Girls Like Me”: Layers of Victimization in Online Dating Romance Scams in Iran. PACM HCI 9(7), CSCW 2025. *Honorable Mention.*
- **Alizadeh, M.**, Lawo, D., Stevens, G., Zytko, D., & Eslami, M. (2024). When the “Matchmaker” Does Not Have Your Interest at Heart: Perceived Algorithmic Harms, Folk Theories, and Users’ Counter-Strategies on Tinder.

PACM HCI 8(CSCW2).

- **Alizadeh, F.**, Tolmie, P., Lee, M., Wintersberger, P., Pins, D., & Stevens, G. (2024). Voice Assistants' Accountability through Explanatory Dialogues. CUI '24.
- Vereschak, O., **Alizadeh, F.**, Bailly, G., & Caramiaux, B. (2024). Trust in AI-Assisted Decision Making: Perspectives from Those Behind the System and Those for Whom the Decision Is Made. CHI '24.
- **Alizadeh, F.**, Stevens, G., Jakobi, T., & Krüger, J. (2023). Catch Me if You Can: "Delaying" as a Social Engineering Technique in the Post-Attack Phase. PACM HCI 7(CSCW1).
- Pins, D., Jakobi, T., Stevens, G., **Alizadeh, F.**, & Krüger, J. (2022). Finding, Getting and Understanding: The User Journey for the GDPR's Right to Access. Behaviour & Information Technology 41(10).
- Pins, D., Jakobi, T., Boden, A., **Alizadeh, F.**, & Wulf, V. (2021). Alexa, We Need to Talk: A Data Literacy Approach on Voice Assistants. DIS '21.
- **Alizadeh, F.**, Stevens, G., & Esau, M. (2021). I Don't Know, Is AI Also Used in Airbags? Folk Concepts and People's Expectations of AI. i-com 20(1).
- Stevens, G., & **Alizadeh, F.** (forthcoming). Scambots: Deception at Scale; Human-Chatbot Relationships. In *Chatbot Psychology*. Cambridge University Press.

35 publications, 520+ citations, h-index 13 (Google Scholar).

AWARDS

2025	Honorable Mention, CSCW 2025
2021	Best Paper Award, Mensch und Computer
2021	Best Poster Award, SOUPS
2020	Teaching Award "Besser studieren", University of Siegen
2019	Usability Challenge Award, Mensch und Computer

TEACHING

- Current Research in Human-Centered AI (2023)
- Participatory Design of Invisible AI (2023)
- Designing Intelligent Interfaces (2022)
- Seamful Design: Visualization of the Invisible AI (2021)
- Sci-fi and the Future of Artificial Intelligence (2021)
- Usable Security and Privacy, teaching assistant (2018–2020)

SERVICE & FELLOWSHIPS

- Associate Chair: CHI 2024, 2026 · CUI 2024, 2025 · ACM GROUP 2027 · CHI LBW 2023 · MuC 2023
- Social Media Co-Chair, Mensch und Computer 2024
- Workshop co-organiser, ECSCW 2022 and ECSCW 2024
- Critical AI Policy Virtual Fellowship, University of Manchester
- Member, HAITeC research network

METHODS

Longitudinal and naturalistic field studies, living labs, interviews and home visits, diary studies, experience sampling, usability testing, experimental chatbot studies, participatory and speculative design, co-creation workshops

LANGUAGES

English, German, Farsi, French